Music Terms Flashcards — Term Set 1

31 terms · Term · definition

Tempo

allargando (allarg.) — Growing broader; gradually slowing down and becoming more stately and emphatic.

rallentando (rall.) — Gradually slowing down the tempo.

ritenuto (riten.) — Held back; an immediate slight slowing of tempo, rather than a gradual one.

meno mosso (meno.) — Less motion; play at a slower tempo.

rubato (tempo rubato) — "Robbed time." Per the Harvard Dictionary of Music: expressive flexibility of tempo — the melody may linger or hurry while the accompaniment keeps steady time, or the whole texture may speed and slow within a phrase.

stringendo (string.) — Pressing forward; hurrying or accelerating the tempo.

accelerando (accel.) — Gradually getting faster.

calando (cal.) — Getting softer and slower; dying down in both volume and speed.

Dynamics

smorzando (smorz.) — Dying away; fading gradually in both sound and tempo.

morendo (mor.) — Dying; fading away to nothing.

perdendosi (perd.) — Dying away; literally "losing itself" — fading into silence.

sforzando (sfz · sf) — A sudden, strong accent on a single note or chord.

sempre (—) — Always; e.g. sempre staccato or sempre pp — continue in the same manner throughout.

rinforzando (rfz · rinf.) — Reinforced; played with special emphasis or stress.

sotto voce (—) — "Under the voice." In a subdued undertone; very softly and restrained.

con forza (—) — With force; forcefully and powerfully.

Expression

appassionato (—) — Impassioned; with intense feeling and passion.

con fuoco (—) — With fire; fiery, blazing, and energetic.

leggiero (—) — Lightly and nimbly; with delicacy and ease.

con brio (—) — With vigor and spirit; lively and spirited.

con moto (—) — With motion; with lively, forward movement.

agitato (—) — Agitated; restless and hurried in character.

maestoso (—) — Majestic; stately and dignified.

scherzando (—) — Playful and joking; lighthearted in character.

Ornaments & Articulation

tenuto (ten.) — Held for its full value; the note is sustained slightly and gently stressed.

marcato (marc.) — Marked; each note played with clear emphasis.

Ornaments & Articulation (cont.)

glissando (gliss.) — Sliding rapidly across consecutive notes, up or down.

appoggiatura (—) — A leaning grace note that borrows half (or two-thirds) of the main note's value, played on the beat.

acciaccatura (—) — A crushed grace note, played very quickly just before the beat.

mordent (—) — Rapid alternation between the written note and the note directly above or below it.

turn (gruppetto · ~) — An ornament circling the main note: upper neighbor, main note, lower neighbor, main note.

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